Capstone Cloud Strategy Canvas

Cloud strategy is not about moving to cloud.

It is about moving the business forward.

Business | Model | ROI | Risk

Session purpose

Apply
2-day learning

Build
strategy canvas

Present
business case

From learning to strategy

Can we convert cloud knowledge into a practical business strategy?

Capstone focus

business-aligned
not technical diagrams

Strategy canvas humour

**Cloud strategy without
a canvas is like
going to a buffet without a plate.**

Message
organize choices clearly

Opening power question

If your business unit starts one cloud initiative in 90 days, what should it be?

Predict | Optimize | Automate | Secure | Measure

Capstone journey

1. Canvas logic
2. Business unit
3. Model + platform
4. ROI + risk
5. Presentation

What is a Cloud Strategy Canvas?

A one-page executive framework that connects business priorities with cloud decisions.

Why canvas-based thinking matters

Business
outcomes

Technology
architecture

Governance
risk + cost

The canvas brings disconnected conversations into one view

Without structure...

Cloud discussions can become like a family WhatsApp group.

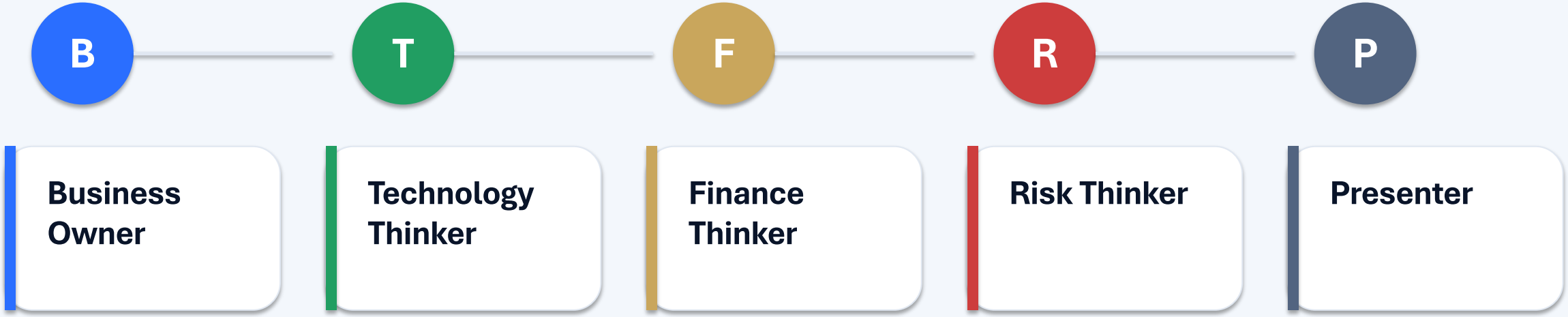
Everyone has opinions.

Decision clarity is optional.

Capstone output | Cloud Strategy Canvas

- Business problem
- Cloud model
- Platform direction
- ROI
- Risk governance
- 90-day plan

Group formation



Role selection humour

Please select roles quickly.

If you do not volunteer, you may still be nominated.

Step 1 | Select business unit / function

Operations

manufacturing

cement

metals

Market-facing

retail

BFSI

telecom

Enabling functions

finance

HR

procurement

Selection criteria

1. Important
2. Visible value
3. Cloud-fit
4. Data/process ready
5. Measurable

Step 2 | Identify business problem

Problem

what is painful?

Impact

who is affected?

Urgency

why now?

Problem examples

- Machine downtime
- Inventory gaps
- Delayed forecasting
- Low conversion
- Manual invoices
- Vendor visibility

Problem framing humour

“We need AI” is not a problem statement.

It is like saying “I need gym membership”

when the real problem is stamina.

Step 3 | Define cloud opportunity

Integrate

data + systems

Scale

capacity + services

Automate

workflow + insight

Cloud opportunity examples

- Slow reporting → analytics
- Downtime → predictive AI
- Inventory gaps → forecasting
- Manual support → SaaS
- Cost overrun → FinOps
- Compliance delay → data platform

Step 4 | Select service model

IaaS

control

migration

PaaS

custom apps

analytics

SaaS

ready workflows

Service model prompts

1. Ready software?
2. Custom build?
3. Infra control?
4. Standard process?
5. Speed required?

Step 5 | Select deployment model

Public

speed + scale

Hybrid

core + innovation

Private / Multi-cloud

control + flexibility

Deployment model prompts

1. Core or innovation?
2. How sensitive is data?
3. How fast to move?
4. What integration?
5. What compliance?

Step 6 | Select platform direction

Azure

Microsoft ecosystem

hybrid

AWS

breadth

scale

GCP

data

AI

Platform direction, not final architecture

Make a strategic recommendation based on business fit.

Ask
which platform direction and why?

Step 7 | Define AI / data opportunity

Dashboard
visibility

Prediction
forecast + alerts

Automation
workflow + decisions

AI / data prompts

1. What data is needed?
2. Is data available?
3. What decision improves?
4. Prediction or dashboard?
5. What governance?

Step 8 | Define ROI and business value

Financial

cost reduction

revenue uplift

Operational

speed

productivity

Risk

resilience

compliance

ROI questions

1. What value will be created?
2. What KPI will improve?
3. What cost is avoided?
4. What risk reduces?
5. How will value be tracked?

ROI humour

ROI should not be a beautiful number created only for approval.

It must be
measurable
trackable
owned

Step 9 | Identify risk and governance

Security

access

privacy

Cost

budget

FinOps

Continuity

backup

ownership

Governance questions

1. Who owns initiative?
2. Who owns data?
3. Who approves access?
4. How monitor cost?
5. What if system fails?

Step 10 | Vendor / partner strategy

Build
unique capability

Buy
standard process

Partner
specialist speed

Vendor questions

1. Which partner type?
2. What SLA is needed?
3. What lock-in risk?
4. What exit clause?
5. Who operates it?

Step 11 | Define success metrics

Operations

downtime

turnaround

Finance

cost

forecast accuracy

Customer / People

conversion

resolution time

Step 12 | 90-day action plan

Days 1–30

problem validation

data discovery

Days 31–60

pilot design

vendor/platform evaluation

Days 61–90

pilot execution

value review

90-day planning prompts

1. What starts in 30 days?
2. What data / approval needed?
3. Who owns the pilot?
4. Which partner to evaluate?
5. What proves success?

Cloud Strategy Canvas template

- Business unit
- Problem
- Impact
- Cloud opportunity
- Service model
- Deployment
- Platform
- AI / data
- ROI
- Risk
- Vendor
- 90-day plan

Group presentation flow | 5 minutes

1. Business unit + problem
2. Cloud model + platform
3. ROI + value
4. Risk + governance
5. 90-day action plan

Peer review questions

- ?
  Problem clear?
- ?
  Model suitable?
- ?
  ROI measurable?
- ?
  Risks identified?
- ?
  Plan realistic?

Example canvas | Predictive maintenance

Problem
downtime

Model
PaaS + hybrid

Value
asset uptime

Metric
downtime reduction

Example canvas | Finance analytics

Problem

delayed cash visibility

Opportunity

forecasting dashboard

Metric

reporting cycle time

Example canvas | Customer personalization

Problem
low conversion

Model
PaaS

AI
next-best offer

Risk
privacy

Scoring and reflection

Scoring

problem clarity
model fit
ROI
governance
90-day plan

Reflect

most practical?
strongest ROI?
highest risk?

Leadership

who supports?
what starts next?

Capstone close

A strong cloud strategy connects business problems, technology choices, financial value, risk governance, and execution discipline.

Capability built

strategic application
business case thinking
execution focus

Thank You

Let’s continue the cloud, AI and digital transformation journey.

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Empowering leaders to make smarter cloud, AI and digital transformation decisions.